

FOR MAC • TAKES ABOUT 10 MINUTES, MOSTLY WAITING

Talk instead of type.

Whisper Flow is a free dictation app for your Mac: hold a key, speak, and your words appear typed wherever your cursor is — email, Slack, docs, anything. It's a private alternative to apps like Wispr Flow.

- 100% private — runs entirely on your Mac, nothing you say is ever sent anywhere

1 CHECK YOU'RE ON THE RIGHT KIND OF MAC

Apple silicon only (M1, M2, M3 or M4)

Click the Apple menu (top-left) → About This Mac. If it says Chip: Apple M1/M2/M3/M4, you're good. If it says Intel, this won't run — let Niall know and stop here.

2 INSTALL OLLAMA (THE ENGINE THAT TIDIES UP YOUR TEXT)

This is a free, well-known tool that runs small AI models on your own Mac. Whisper Flow uses it to clean up filler words and punctuation — still all on your machine, no internet involved.

Download and open Ollama

Go to ollama.com/download/mac and click

Download for macOS

. Open the downloaded file and drag the Ollama icon into your Applications folder, then open Ollama from there. A small llama icon appears near the top-right of your screen (menu bar) — leave it running.

Download the language model (one-time, ~2GB)

Open

Terminal

: press  Space, type Terminal, press Enter. Paste the line below in (right-click → Paste, or  V) and press Enter:

```
ollama pull llama3.2:3b
```

It'll show a progress bar. Once it says success, this step is done for good — you won't need Terminal again after this.

3 DOWNLOAD AND INSTALL WHISPER FLOW

Get the app

[Download Whisper Flow](#)

Double-click the downloaded `WhisperFlow.zip` to unzip it, then drag `WhisperFlow.app` into your

Applications

folder.

First time only: macOS will warn you

This app isn't from the App Store, so macOS shows a warning the first time. Here's how to open it anyway:

- **Control-click**
(or right-click) `WhisperFlow.app` in Applications, then choose **Open**
- A dialog appears saying it's from an unidentified developer — click **Open** again

You only need to do this once. After that it opens normally.

4 GRANT TWO PERMISSIONS

macOS will ask for these the first time you use it — both are required for Whisper Flow to work.

Accessibility

Lets Whisper Flow "type" your words into whatever app you're using, and listen for your hotkey. A prompt appears on first launch — click

Open System Settings

and turn the toggle on for Whisper Flow. (If you miss it, click the mic icon in your menu bar → Grant Accessibility...)

Microphone

Needed so it can hear you. A normal "Whisper Flow would like to access the Microphone" prompt appears the first time you dictate — click

Allow

.

5 HOW TO USE IT

Start dictating

Click where you want the text to go (an email, a document, any text box), then press  **Command** + **Right ⌥ Option** (the Option key on the right of the spacebar). A small pill appears at the bottom of your screen showing it's listening. Just speak — no need to hold anything down.

Finish or cancel

When you're done talking,

press any key

— your cleaned-up text is typed right where your cursor was. Changed your mind? Press  **esc** instead and nothing is typed. (The key you press is swallowed — it won't end up in your document.)

Where did the app go?

Whisper Flow lives in your

menu bar

(top of the screen, next to the clock/wifi icons) — not the Dock. Click the mic icon there any time to check it's running or see status.

Questions or something not working? Message Niall directly — this is a new tool, so early feedback is genuinely useful.

Whisper Flow runs entirely on your own Mac. Your voice and your text never leave your machine — nothing is uploaded, logged externally, or sent to any company, including VERVE. ← [Back to Flow](#)